



MsBelindaAllen

POWER BI 101

A How-To Workshop
for Accounting Professionals

Duration: **2 Hours**

MsBelindaAllen — Accounting Professionals Series

About Belinda Allen

From Alcolu, SC

- I lived the longest in New York City

In Technology

- Principal Enablement Consultant – iLink Digital
- Started in tech in 1991
- Microsoft Partner since 2001

Microsoft MVP

- 14 years / 5 years GP and 9 years Power BI

Microsoft MCT

- 15 years (with a hiatus in the middle)

Co-Authored 2 books

- BI and Dynamics GP

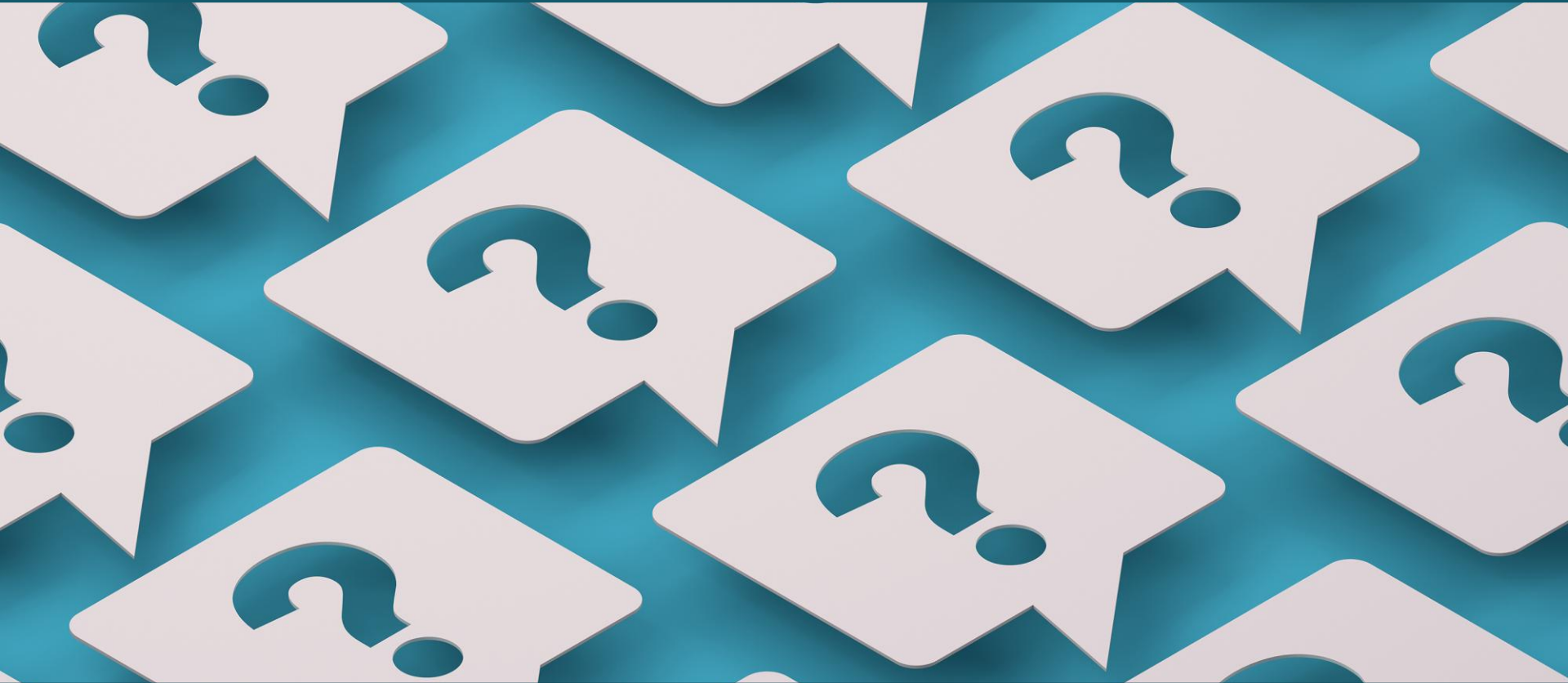
I love learning

- Technology, Wood Turning, Cooking

I love hobbies

- Knitting/Crocheting, Reiki

Poll questions



WORKSHOP AGENDA

Intro	Introduction & Learning Objectives
1	Module 1 — What Is Power BI?
2	Module 2 — Free vs. Paid Versions
3	Module 3 — Power BI in Accounting
4	Module 4 — Demo GL
Close	Wrap-Up, Resources & Q&A

WHAT IS POWER BI?

Microsoft's business analytics platform that enables users to:

Connect to 100+ data sources

Transform raw data with Power Query

Model relationships between data tables

Visualize with interactive charts & reports

Share with colleagues and clients

*"Think of Excel as your
data warehouse.
Power BI is your showroom."*

NOT a replacement for Excel —
a complement to it.

WHAT IS Fabric?

MODULE 1



Microsoft Fabric



Data
Factory



Real-Time
Intelligence



Databases



Analytic
s



Industry
Solutions



Power BI



Partner
solutions



Copilot in Fabric



OneLake

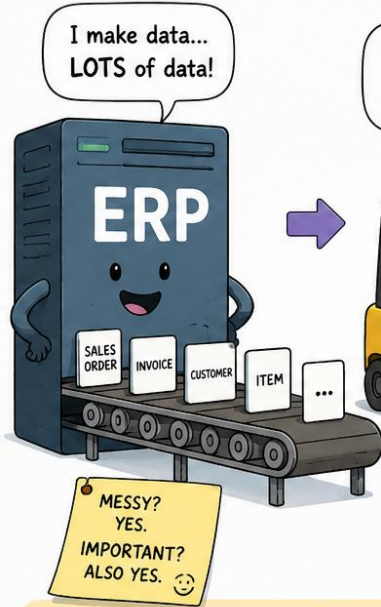


Microsoft Purview

THE EPIC JOURNEY OF DATA

FROM ERP TO POWER BI

1. IN ERP: WHERE
DATA IS BORN



2. EXTRACT: THE
DATA GETS PACKED



3. TRANSFORM & LOAD:
DATA SPA DAY

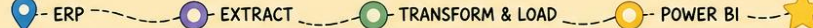


4. POWER BI:
THE GRAND FINALE



THE MORAL OF THE STORY:

DATA MAY HAVE A LONG JOURNEY... BUT THE DESTINATION IS WORTH IT!



POWERED BY:
CURIOSITY, COFFEE,
AND A GOOD DATA MODEL



THE POWER BI ECOSYSTEM



Power BI Desktop

Free Windows app

Authoring tool — where you connect, clean, model, and design reports. Start here.



Power BI Service

app.powerbi.com

Cloud platform for publishing, sharing, and scheduling automatic data refresh.



Power BI Mobile

iOS & Android

View and interact with published reports on any device. Read-only.

HOW IT FITS WITH YOUR EXISTING TOOLS

Excel / CSV

Native import — no connector needed

SQL Databases

Direct query or import mode

QuickBooks Online

Built-in connector in Get Data menu

SharePoint / OneDrive

Reads Excel files from cloud storage

Sage / NetSuite / Dynamics

ERP connectors available

Azure Data Warehouse

Enterprise-scale data connectivity

KEY CONCEPTS

01

Dataset

The underlying data source — imported or connected. The foundation of every report.

03

Dashboard

Curated collection of pinned visuals from reports — your executive summary view.

02

Report

One or more pages of interactive charts, tables, and KPI visuals built from a dataset.

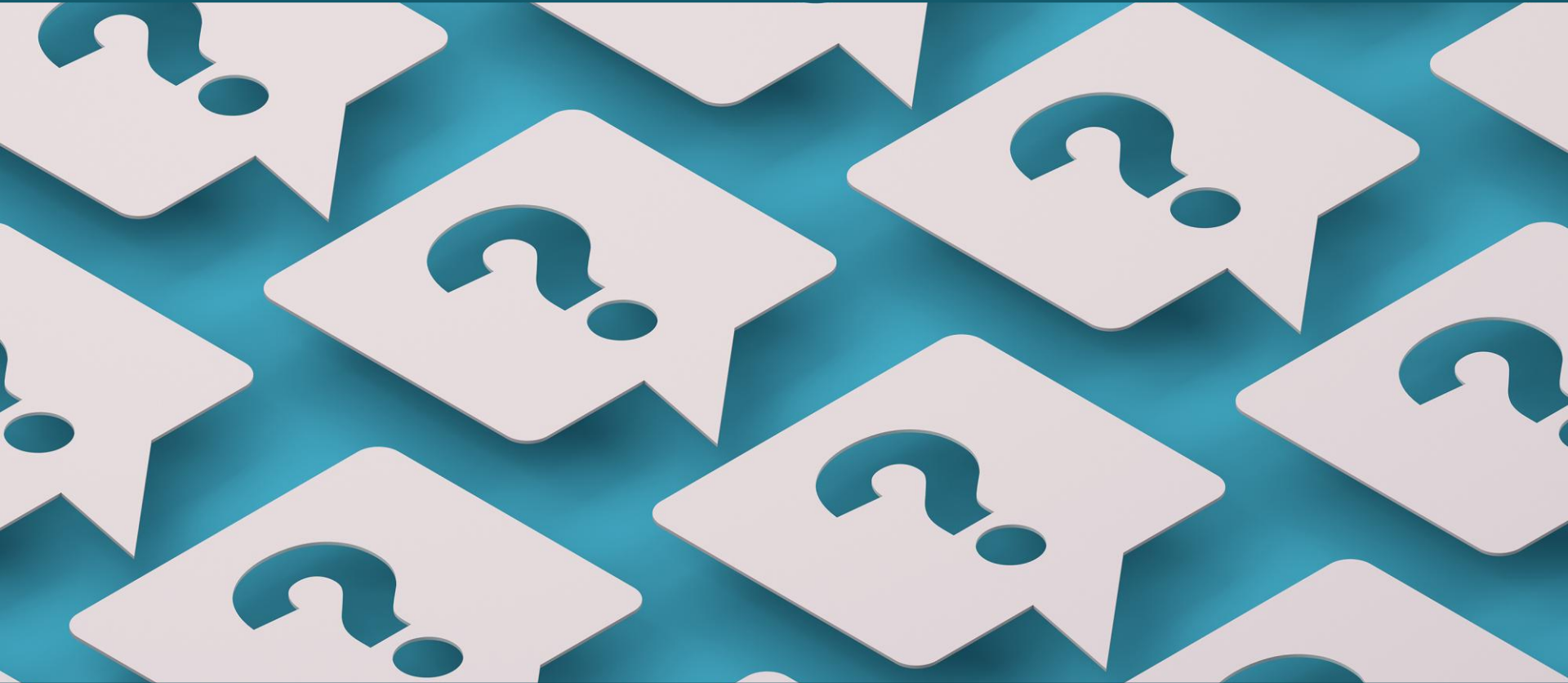
04

Workspace

Shared folder in the cloud where your team accesses and collaborates on reports.



Poll questions



FREE vs. PAID — WHICH VERSION DO YOU NEED?

MODULE 2

✓ Power BI Free (Desktop)

Full report authoring — locally

Connect to 100+ data sources

All visuals & DAX calculations

Publish to personal workspace

No sharing or collaboration

Cost: \$0

★ Power BI Pro / Premium / Fabric

Everything in Free, plus:

Share reports with colleagues

Scheduled automatic data refresh

Row-level security controls

Embedded analytics (Premium)

Pro: ~\$14/user/month



DECISION GUIDE

Solo Practitioner

→ **Free Desktop**

Personal analysis & internal use — no sharing needed

Small Firm (2–10 users)

→ **Power BI Pro**

~\$14/user/mo enables sharing, collaboration & refresh

Large Firm / Enterprise

→ **Premium Capacity**

Per-org licensing, viewer licenses included, AI features

💡 **Check your Microsoft 365 subscription first — E5 and Business Premium may already include Power BI Pro!**

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE



**Client data
security
built-in**

Azure Infrastructure

SOC 2, ISO 27001, and HIPAA compliant cloud hosting

Encryption

Data encrypted at rest and in transit by default

Row-Level Security

Restrict what each user sees within a shared report

Offline Option

Desktop works fully offline — no cloud required

MODULE 3

POWER BI IN ACCOUNTING

8 Real-World Use Cases for CPAs

1. Financial Reporting

2. GL Analysis

3. Budget vs. Actual

4. AP / AR Aging

5. Audit Support

6. Client Dashboards

7. Workflow Mgmt

8. Cash Flow Reporting

1

Financial Reporting

Automated P&L, Balance Sheet & Cash Flow. Reports update when books close — no manual formatting.

3

Budget vs. Actual

Load budget + actuals side-by-side. Auto-calculate variance with conditional color coding.

2

GL Analysis

Drill from summary to transaction in 2 clicks. Filter by account, dept, date, and project in real time.

4

AP / AR Aging

Dynamic aging buckets (current, 30/60/90+) that update automatically with each data refresh.

USE CASES 5-7 + DEMO

MODULE 3

5. Audit Support

Flag duplicate payments, Benford's Law anomalies, and off-hours postings automatically.

6. Client Dashboards

Replace static PDF reports with live, interactive dashboards clients can access anytime.

7. Workflow Management

Track engagement deadlines, filing status, and staff capacity across your entire client list.

LIVE DEMO

Show 8. Modern, Visual Cash Flow Statements



MODULE 4

Demo

Build Your First GL Report



1

Import GL Data

2

Build Data Model

3

Create DAX Measures

4

Build Visuals

5

Publish & Share

STEP 1 — IMPORT THE GL DATA

STEP 1 / 5

1 Get Data → Excel Workbook or GitHub online

2 Select the GL Transactions table

3 Click Transform Data (Power Query)

4 Verify data types: Date, Decimal, Text

5 Close & Apply

Expected GL Columns

Date	Date type
Account Code	Text
Account Name	Text
Department	Text
Debit	Decimal
Credit	Decimal
Account Type	Text

STEPS 2 & 3 — DATA MODEL + DAX MEASURES

STEP 2-3

Data Model — Model View

- GL Transactions $\leftarrow \rightarrow$ Date Table
- GL Transactions $\leftarrow \rightarrow$ Chart of Accounts
- Mark Date table for time intelligence

DAX Measures — Right-click table $\rightarrow$ New Measure

Total Revenue

```
= CALCULATE( SUM( GL_Transactions[Amount] ), GL_Transactions[AccountType] = "Revenue" )
```

Total Expenses

```
= CALCULATE( SUM( GL_Transactions[Amount] ), GL_Transactions[AccountType] = "Expense" )
```

Net Income

```
= [Total Revenue] - [Total Expenses]
```

STEP 4 — BUILD THE REPORT VISUALS

STEP 4 / 5

KPI

KPI Card

Field: [Net Income]

Shows net income — top left of canvas

TBL

Detail Table

Field: Account, Dept, Date, Amount

Add all columns, enable column filters

BAR

Bar Chart

Field: Date → Revenue by Month

X-axis: Month, Y-axis: [Total Revenue]

SLC

Slicer

Field: Department field

Cross-filters ALL other visuals on the page



Power BI 101 — GL Financial Dashboard

Total Revenue

\$842,500

Total Expenses

\$631,200

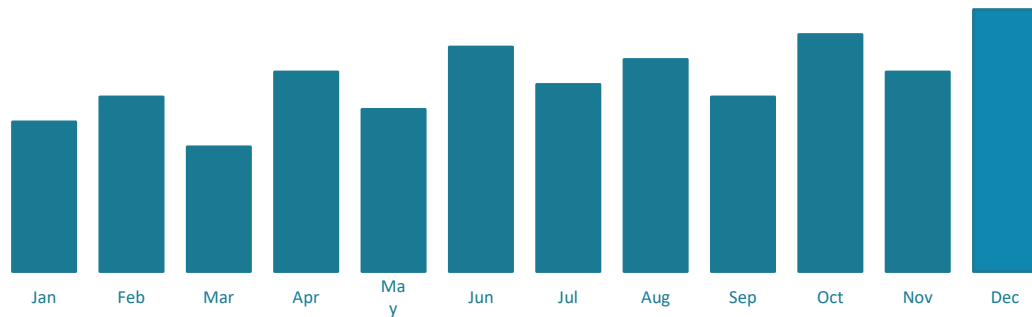
Net Income

\$211,300

Dept Slices

6 Active

Revenue by Month



GL Transactions

Account	Amount
Revenue — Sales	\$72,400
COGS	\$ (31,200)
Payroll Exp	\$ (18,500)
Rent Exp	\$ (4,200)
Utilities	\$ (1,100)
Net	\$17,400

STEP 5 — SAVE & PUBLISH

STEP 5 / 5

Save

File → Save As → name your report → saves as .pbix file

Publish

Home ribbon → Publish → sign in → choose My Workspace

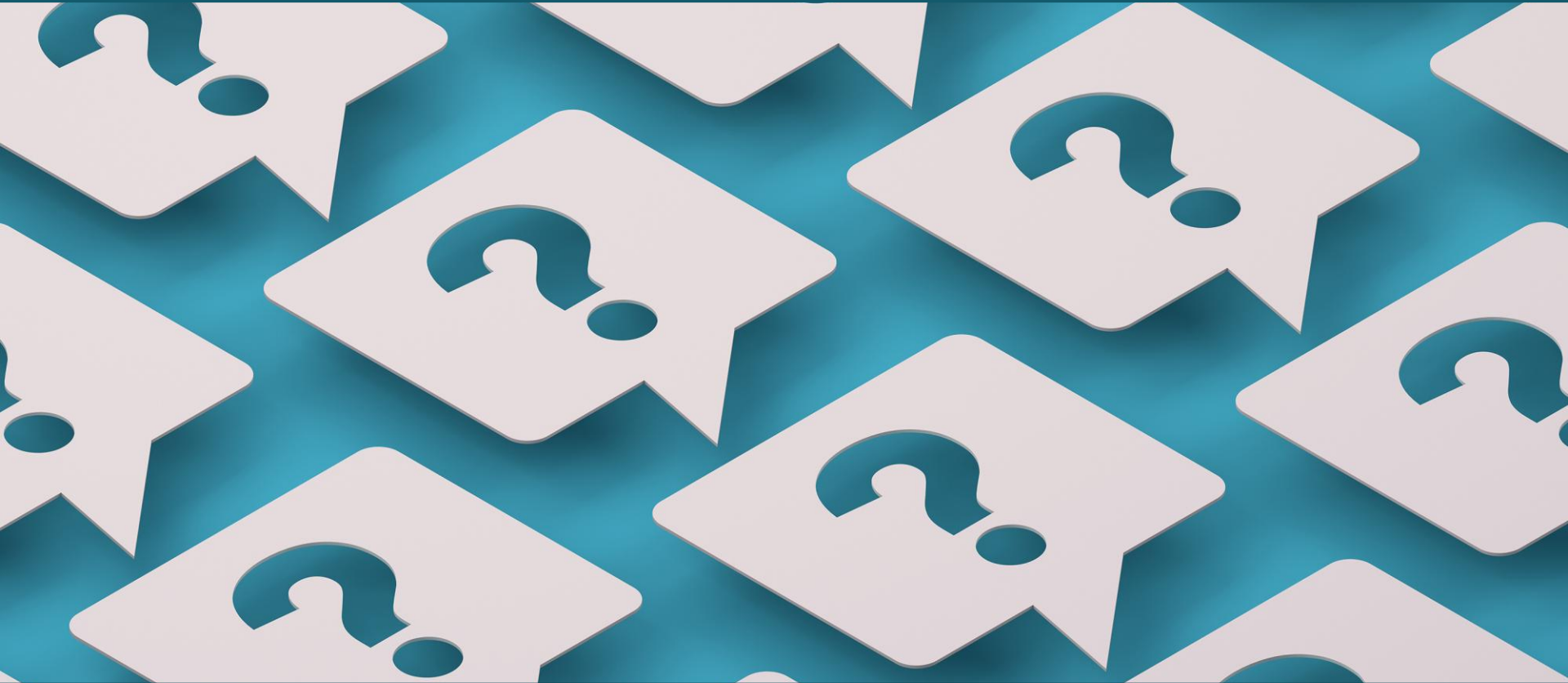
View in browser

Open the link provided — report loads in Power BI Service

Share (Pro)

Share button → enter colleague or client email address

Poll questions



SESSION RECAP

Module 1

Power BI is free to start. Desktop for authoring. Service for sharing. Mobile for viewing.

Module 2

Free version handles all authoring. Upgrade to Pro (~\$14/mo) when collaboration is needed.

Module 3

8 accounting use cases: reporting, GL analysis, variance, aging, audit, client dashboards, workflow, cash flow

Module 4

Import → Model → DAX → Visualize → Publish. You built a working GL report today.

NEXT STEPS & RESOURCES

1

Download Power BI Desktop

powerbi.microsoft.com — FREE

2

Complete the MS Learn path

'Power BI Fundamentals' — ~8 hrs, self-paced, free

3

Check your M365 license

E5/Business Premium may already include Pro

4

Join the community

community.powerbi.com — templates, Q&A, support

5

Read: Definitive Guide to DAX

Russo & Ferrari — the definitive DAX reference book



Thank You!

Q&A



www.MsBelindaAllen.com

Questions & Discussion

Discussion prompts (if needed):

1. What data source in your practice would you connect to Power BI first?
2. What reporting task takes the most manual effort today?
3. Has anyone here already used Power BI or a similar tool?

Requested topic for blog posting

